Nicolas Bastias-Campos

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Last updated: November 2026

Education

Universidad de Chile

Bachelor in Economics (*with Honors*) 2019–2024

I also completed five courses from the Master's in Economics program at the University of Chile, including Math Camp, Microeconomics I, Econometrics I, Topics in Economic History, and Advanced Methods for Empirical Industrial Organization. At Stanford University, I took Applied Causal Inference Powered by ML and AI (MS&E 228).

Research Interests

- **Primary:** Development Economics, Public and Labor Economics, Health Economics.
- **Secondary:** Applied Microeconomics, Causal Inference & Econometrics, Economic History.

Research Projects

"The Effect of Drug Consumption Among Adolescents on Crime Rates: A Community-Level Approach." [Link]

"Economic Policy Uncertainty and Macroeconomic Dynamics in Latin America." [Link]

Professional Experience

Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research (SIEPR) Jul. 2025 – Present

— & Health Inequality Lab (HIL)

Predoctoral Research Fellow. Principal Investigator: Marcella Alsan.

I work as a research assistant on projects at the intersection of health economics and political economy, labor economics, and economic history. My responsibilities included supporting the R&R of "Why the US Doesn't Have a National Health Insurance", published in the *Quarterly Journal of Economics*; deploying surveys, conducting statistical analyses, and implementing a latent variable structural model to estimate physicians' preferences for unionization for "Patients Over Profits? Preferences for Unionization among U.S. Physicians"; and analyzing historical data on health insurance in the United Kingdom.

The Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL) Dec. 2024 – Present

— & Inter-American Development Bank (IDB) Mar. 2025 – Jul. 2025

Research Assistant. Principal Investigator: Claudia Martinez.

I worked on evaluating the impact of two micro-entrepreneurship programs (RCTs) led by Professor Claudia Martinez in Chile. My responsibilities included conducting event study analyses to evaluate program treatment effects using administrative data, estimating treatment effects

with post-double-Lasso and double machine learning, and applying Generic Machine Learning to analyze treatment effect heterogeneity on survey and administrative data.

Instituto Milenio para la Investigación en Imperfecciones de Mercado y Políticas Públicas (MIPP) Jul. 2024 – Feb. 2025

Research Assistant. Principal Investigator: Damian Clarke.

I worked as a research assistant on topics related to applied microeconometrics and machine learning. My responsibilities included reviewing theoretical and applied literature, developing applied exercises for the book "Applied Microeconometrics", and contributing to the development of two statistical packages in Stata for panel data and event study analysis (matrix completion with nuclear norm, and matching in event studies).

Centro de Estudios Públicos (CEP) Nov. 2022 – May 2023

Research Assistant. Principal Investigator: Gabriel Ugarte.

I worked as a research assistant on topics related to education and public policy. My responsibilities included reviewing national and international literature on the educational challenges caused by the COVID-19 pandemic, analyzing mitigation measures and public investments implemented in other countries, conducting simulations to estimate the long-term economic and fiscal impacts of human capital losses in Chile, and drafting internal reports and policy briefs. This work concluded with the writing and publication of the article "Crisis educacional escolar pospandemia" at CEP.

Teaching Experience

I have served as a teaching assistant for thirteen courses across three institutions.

University of Chile 2022 – 2024

Mathematics and Econometrics: Linear Algebra, Calculus, Econometrics (×3).

Microeconomics: Principles of Microeconomics, Labor Economics, Behavioral Economics.

Macroeconomics: Principles of Macroeconomics, Growth & International Trade.

Others: Public Policy Workshop.

Diego Portales University 2023

Microeconomics: Intermediate Microeconomics.

University of Exeter 2024

Data Science: Data Science for Economists.

Others

Statistical software: Stata (advanced, programming level), Python (intermediate), R (intermediate), MATLAB (basic).

Tools: LaTeX (advanced), GitHub, Quarto, VS Code, AI coding tools (Claude Code).

Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent)

Citizenship: Chilean